

Power Tips

■ Almost all digital cameras come with an automatic adjustable zoom lens, which you can also adjust manually. If you have kept it to auto, press the shutter button halfway, then press it completely to take the picture. This will adjust the focus of the lens, and give you sharp focused results.

■ To allow your LCD screen to consume less power, always keep the powersave mode on. Almost all cameras have an LCD-off option, which can be used to save power.

■ If the camera comes with a power adapter, keep it connected to the device while transferring images to a PC, especially a camera with the RS-232 (serial) connection which has very slow transfer rate.



- While choosing a camera don't only go for the features; but also look for its ergonomics. While taking snaps, see that the button is within reach of your fingers, and that your fingers do not come in the way of the lens or flash.
- Never keep the resolution to the maximum, if you are only going to view it on the PC screen. For such

photographs 1,024 x 768 is the ideal resolution.

■ Always remove the batteries if you are not going to use the camera for a while, because batteries can leak and damage the camera.

■ When on the road, remember to carry many sets of batteries or invest in rechargeable ones—digital cameras have a way of chewing through batteries and you wouldn't want to miss a great photo opportunity.



Digital camera vs Web camera

■ Web cams usually don't feature resolutions over 640 x 480 if you use them for taking snaps, whereas digital cameras can easily provide a resolution of 1280 x 960 pixels.

■ A Web cam cannot take pictures when not connected to a PC since it draws power from the interface cable. Digital cameras, on the other hand, have their own power source and are capable of taking photographs—and even recording small video clips.

■ Some high-end cameras come with a built-in microphone to record audio while recording the video clip, whereas Web cams need a microphone connected to the PC separately to record audio.

■ Digital cameras have adjustable focal length, which is not the case with Web cams.

Under the bonnet of a Digital Cameras

HOW A DIGITAL CAMERA WORKS

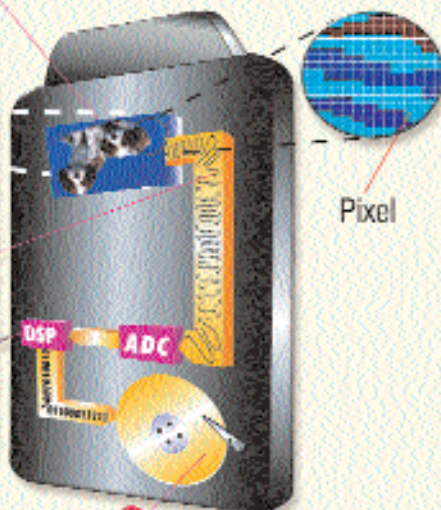
1 Light passes through the lens of a digital camera in the same way as it does in a film-camera



3 The ADC converts the image from the CCD into digital signals

4 The ADC sends the digital information to a digital signal processor, which processes the image and then compresses it

2 The image is focused on the CCD



5 The image is stored on the storage medium, which varies according to the camera